

Sunday, October 23

The day began warm but cooled off with rain and an icy wind. Winter will be here soon. Every year we are mentally less prepared for it. We took Peter to Sunday School, drove around with coffees from McDonald's, then picked up Cheryl's mom for church. They went to the hospital after dinner. They found Papa sitting in the TV room with several old women. He shares a room with three men. There's a chance he'll be bumped up to a single.

Cheryl went to Suzuki piano with Carol at 3.

Matthew slept for a while, first in his crib then in my lap. When he woke I read beginner books to him. He flipped the pages back and forth, asking, 'Whats'is?', without waiting for an answer. Peter, Matthew and I went to Lakeview Park. I threw Peter's bike in the Mazda. Peter held Matthew in his lap. Matthew and I walked on the grass while Peter rode on the sidewalk. He was in his red 'Wolf' sweatshirt and brown fuzzy-on-the-inside vest. A group of boys were playing football. A stray ball bounced near us. Matthew picked it up, threw it, fell over. The game stopped. Someone yelled, 'Sign him up.' The wind was cool. Matthew's eyes teared and his face was red. Back home the three of us played Snakes and Ladders. I lost. Peter made a jigsaw puzzle.

After supper we watched Walt Disney cartoons, which Peter and Matthew both laughed at. I went to school for a half hour. Cheryl picked up her mother from the hospital.

Matthew's latest words: 'Oh dear,' 'Key' (kitty), 'ni' (nice), 'gedow' (get down).